

Building Faith, God's faithfulness towards us

Transcript of the God's Design podcast episode

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G'day and welcome to this podcast. I'm your host Ashton. Today we're going to continue with the series Building Faith. Today we're going to look at God's stance on faith in the kingdom of heaven and the purpose of his stance on faith. And then we're going to look at our stance and why we should mirror and reflect God's heavenly stance on faith here upon the earth. Galatians 3 verse 29 reads, and this is the Amplified Version, it says, And if you belong to Christ, that is, are in him who is Abram's seed, then you are Abram's offspring and spiritual is according to the promise.

The Israelites were from birth and that is from Abram's seed or Abram's lineage were the chosen people that God had yet upon the earth to bring the saviour for mankind, to be a light unto the nations. We, after Christ Jesus, were then adopted into the family of God by faith. Our adoption in no way restricts us or limits us from inheriting God's kingdom. And God's faithfulness towards us is the same faithfulness he had towards the Israelites when they were in Egypt.

That is, he is willing to move any obstacle out of our way so that we can be reunited with him. Proof of this faithfulness is in Christ Jesus and his sacrifice upon the cross for us. There is a shadow of this within the Bible. In the Bible, we see when Joseph was taken to Egypt, that when Jacob arrived, Jacob then adopted Joseph's sons. Joseph's sons was a mixture of the Jew and the Egyptian. These boys grew up in the Egyptian culture and had Egyptian influences over their lives.

Then Jacob makes a prophetic statement that he is going to adopt both boys into the family on equal terms. At this point, Joseph has to agree to hand over his rights as the boy's father to Jacob. The boys have to agree, they have a new father in Jacob. And more importantly, they exchanged the world's palace for a life of shepherd boys. Just like us today, we have made the choice to be adopted into the kingdom of God by faith through Christ Jesus. So let's look at God's role in faith within our lives.

We are, by nature, open to the opinions of others, open to worldly temptations. We are open to giving in to the call of the body and soul. These are three primary areas that open doors for us to be unfaithful towards God. People lack faith because they themselves don't believe God will be faithful unto them. And so we carry this notion with us every day that God is faithful to others and is just, well, kind of not faithful towards us. But the truth is that our belief in God is flawed.

And so we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are,
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we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are, we are,
we are, we are, God himself will always be faithful towards us because we see that God is
always faithful in all circumstances, trials, and tribulations.

This allows us to build our faith in him. There are two words that describe God in the Bible accurately. One of them is faithful and the other one is steadfast. Both these English words come from the same Hebrew word, Aman. Deuteronomy chapter 7 verse 9 reads, Know therefore that the Lord thy God, he is God, the faithful God, which keepeth covenant and mercy with them that love him and keep his commandments to a thousand generations. So this first verse says that God covers you for four thousand years.

Psalm 78 verse 8 reads, And might not be as their fathers, a stubborn and rebellious generation, A generation that set not their heart aright, and whose spirit was not steadfast with God. In the same chapter verse 37 says, For their heart was not right with him, neither were they steadfast in his covenant. Isaiah chapter 49 verse 7 reads, Thus saith the Lord, the Redeemer of Israel, and the Holy One, To him whom man despiseth, to him whom the nations abhorreth, To a servant of rulers, kings shall see and arise, Princes also shall worship, because of the Lord that is faithful, And the Holy One of Israel, and the Holy One of Israel, and he shall choose thee.

Psalms 119 verse 86 reads, All thy commandments are faithful, They persecute me wrongfully, Help thou me. So this root word used in these verses, Amman, Means to confirm, Support, Believe, Believed, Believes, Bring, Carried, Confirmed, Doorpost, Endure, Enduring, Established, Faithful, Firm, Fulfilled, Guardians, Has assurance, Have faith, Have assurance, Lasting, Nurse, Put your trust, Puts, Trust, Reared, Reliable, Standstill, Sure, Trust, Trusted, Trustworthy, Verified.

The full definition of Amman means, To build up, To support, To foster as a parent, To be morally true, To go to the right hand, To nurse as a father. In the definition of the word Amman, It also describes Amunah, Translated as firm. If you read Psalm chapter 89, 1 to 5, And then take the word faithfulness out of it, And put in the word firm, It will read, Your firmness will you establish in the very heavens, Unchangeable and perpetual. You have said, I have made a covenant with my chosen, I have sworn to David my servant, Your seed I will establish forever, And I will build up your throne in all generations.

Sela, Which means pause and calmly think of them. Let heaven, the angels, praise your wonder, O Lord, your faithfulness, or your firmness, always in the assembly of the Holy Ones. God is prepared to stand firmly next to you. God is prepared to support the congregation that you are also in. I encourage you to read the entire Psalm 89 verses 1 to 5 and replace those words with firmness. The next word is steadfast. Strong's says that steadfast is yatsak and the root for it is to pour, cast, flow.

I'm not going to read all those other words there, but the full definition of yatsak means to pour out, to place firmly, to cleave and grow fast, meaning to glue together. And the final word is stand. Strong's, the word is amad. The root word means to take one's stand, abiding, act. And there's about 40 other words that also come in the definition of it, which again, I'm not going to read, but the full definition is to rise, to accomplish, to continue, to rise up as on eagles' wings.

Amad can therefore be said to mean to rise up as a son or heir or to be ordained as a son or heir. All these Hebrew words carry the intent, purpose and destiny of a father. They also bring the understanding that we must focus our relationship as sons and daughters of a father. And with this, we start to see a clearer picture of who God is, a God who pours himself out, cleaves to us until we have grown together. Who will build up our character and mental values, will support us through every difficulty, will raise you up to fly on eagles' wings.

So now the question to you is, what image of God do you have imprinted on your spirit and soul that will cause you to doubt him, that he won't be faithful towards you? When a certain religious group became popular, they changed the whole scope of faith. They said, you must become holy and you must do this with praying and fasting and so on and paying monies to get yourself out of hell. And they came with all these funny doctrines. And when you do all of this, then you're going to be loved by God, which is according to them.

But we know that our covenantal style is relationship before obedience, listening before doing, reacting in God's ways before my own ego. Most people don't have the Trinity inside of them. They got the Holy Quadruple. God the Father, God the Son, God the Holy Spirit, and God the

Ego. That is their ego. And their ego overrides everybody else. Because if they're not satisfied, then the will of God cannot be done. So being steadfast and faithful, therefore comes a part of your and my nature when we accept that God is good.

We accept that God is our stronger partner and will always do what he has promised. To do. So all of this doesn't mean you won't have trials in your life. Abram followed God. He moves to Canaan. He builds prayer altars. Yet he had to survive a famine. Jacob also has a vision of God. He builds an altar to God and he also had to survive a famine. Throughout these famines, God promised his men that they would multiply. If they walk in obedience, and this is the mistake most Christians make when they use their five senses to interpret the spiritual things of God, your circumstances may not look, feel, or taste like the prophetic promises and blessings you have been given.

Your fellow believer may look and act like they are extremely and abundantly living in blessing. However, those who stand steadfast and faithful will know that God is changing the infrastructure. He is changing the climate and the culture of those around you so that his plans can come into place. You see, sometimes the area around you has to change in order to handle the blessings of God. And you have to be patient in God. And you have to be patient in God's changing of things for your life.

Ruth was a steadfast woman. Ruth 1 verse 18 reads, When Naomi saw that Ruth was determined to go with her, she said, No more. Ruth gives us the attribution of a woman of God. She gives us all those attributes. Ruth's circumstances, her circumstances, however, at face value certainly do not seem to reflect a child of the kingdom of light. You must remember, although Ruth was a Moabite, she is adopted into the kingdom of God when she willingly accepts the call.

And she tells Naomi, You know, wherever you go, I'll go. Your God will be my God. Your people will be my people. Where you die, I will die. And yet, as a child of the King of Kings, she lived in poverty, begging for a meal. But regardless of the hardship, Ruth listens to the quiet voice of the Holy Spirit, looks for the touch of a blessing from God, Ruth lives humbly and obedient lifestyle of a godly woman, honouring her mother-in-law, Naomi. Ruth was determined to go.

And if we look at the original context of the word determined, or the original text of the word determined, in the Strong's, it says, Amets, the primitive root word is to be stout, strong, bold, alert. And of course, they have all those other examples, which I'm not going to read. So the full definition of Amets means to be courageous, to be steadfastly minded, to fortify and

strengthen oneself. Paul tells us we must stand steadfast in faith. The question that you need to ask yourself is this.

Do I try to build my faith through works of prayer, fasting, ministry, and so on? Or do I strive for a greater intimacy with my Father? When you truly know your Father, you will live at peace in spite of and in the midst of every circumstance that prevails. Why? Because you will know that the... Father God is changing the spiritual space and dimensions in the heaven above you and as well as on earth. This is in fact a time to meet God intimately in prayer as an act of worship, to hear what he has to say, to study the word so that you will know God's character.

Act on every action that God and the Holy Spirit reveals, irrespective of the physical domain surrounding you. Do not let your eyes deter you. Enter into warfare and claim back your inheritance, like Isaac when he went to take the stones of circumstance out of his well of blessings. As you grow deeper into an understanding and relationship of intimacy with Abba Father, you will put your faith in his faithfulness and never be disappointed. Then you can be like Deuteronomy chapter 7 verse 9 that says, Know, recognize and understand therefore that the Lord, your God, he is God, the faithful God.

He keeps covenant and steadfast love and mercy with those who love him and keep his commandments to a thousand generations. And 1 Thessalonians chapter 5 from verse 23 to 24 says, And may the God of peace himself sanctify you through and through, that is separate from your profane things, make you pure and holy, consecrated to God. And may your spirit and soul and body be preserved, sound and complete and found blameless at the coming of the Lord Jesus Christ, the Messiah.

Faithful is he who is calling you to himself and utterly trustworthy, and he will do it, fulfill his call by hollering and keeping you. You see, God is faithful, and that is why it is for us to have faith in his faithfulness towards us. Let us sit back and contemplate on the goodness of God, and not allow the circumstances around us to deter us from believing that our Father is for us, building us up to be heirs of the kingdom of heaven. God bless you all.